

crazy. I told myself, "What are you doing here?"

And now, in my fifth season, I am the national team coach and also the coach of one of the biggest clubs in India. I've never spent five years in any country other than my own. It's [India is] like my second country. I think everyone treats me better than I deserve. I am very satisfied and will remember this experience all my life. I hope for more years here.

Speaking of the national team, is this the most challenging season for you? Obviously, the dual role brings the pressure of two jobs, but in terms of scrutiny, do you feel there are more eyes on you right now?

Everyone's opinion can be different. I think I need to be calmer and say simple things because I tend to talk a lot. But sometimes when you speak the truth or describe reality, people will say he cannot manage both jobs.

If Goa is working, [then they will say] he is not focusing on the national team, or if it's the opposite, or if I am struggling at both jobs. Ultimately, you have to focus on the present.

Obviously, I spend more time with my club, FC Goa. Practically, I don't miss many training sessions while with the national team. One thing that happens in national teams around the world is that they don't have much time for training. So, I can manage both jobs. You can never promise good results, but you can promise a lot of effort and professionalism.

I think I can handle it, but I am not stupid — it's not normal to share [two jobs]. [But] it's not the first time, and it won't be the last.

I can do it because of my knowledge of Indian football and Indian players. I don't know if it's good or bad, but it's there. After five seasons, I know all the players in the ISL and all the Indian players in the I-League.

Since it's an unusual situation, can you talk about any unique challenges you have faced in these



two months trying to juggle these two jobs?

I can tell you that I worked more than one job when I was young, and not just in football. In football, I remember training both the main team at one club and an Under-13 or Under-14 team. But it's not the same.

The publicity is very big because you're coaching both a national team and a club. If people talk about time, you do have enough time to

manage both jobs correctly. Whether the results are good or not, that's different.

You previously mentioned in an interview with *Sportstar* that you wanted a clear fixture plan months in advance before the new season begins. Now there is uncertainty over the Super Cup and the additional AFC slot on offer.

This is the main problem in India,